

Bharti Airtel to deploy Ericsson's 5G solution

In accordance with India's ambitious 5G plans, Bharti Airtel has selected Ericsson to deploy its 5G-ready Cloud Packet Core in Airtel's pan-India core network. Ericsson Cloud Packet Core is built on Ericsson's market-leading virtual Evolved Packet Core (vEPC) applications. The deployment will consist of solutions like Ericsson vEPG that follow ETSI standards. It will enhance the capacity in Airtel's network and enable the network to address the rapidly-growing demand for high-speed data services.

Tech Mahindra, Keysight collaborate to accelerate adoption of 5G devices globally

Tech Mahindra has announced an extended collaboration with Keysight to support leading mobile operators achieve their goals of successfully deploying new 5G devices. Due to low latency and high range, 5G devices will be the key catalyst behind the expansion of vehicle-to-everything (V2X) communications, that is, passing of information from a vehicle to any entity like vehicle, infrastructure and grid that may affect the vehicle, and *vice versa*.

NXP India joins India-Netherlands Technology Summit 2019

NXP India has joined the inaugural ceremony of India-Netherlands Technology Summit 2019 to strengthen the semiconductor ecosystem between the two countries. In the presence of Royal Dutch couple—King Willem-Alexander and Queen Maxima—and senior cabinet ministers of both countries, NXP India signed the memorandum of understanding (MoU) with HCL Technologies for next-gen advanced electronics and semiconductor products development. The MoU signifies a strong technology collaboration between the two technology giants to co-develop the automotive product family for global automotive customers.

Kolkata's New Town soon to be dazzled with automated LED streetlights

Kolkata's bustling New Town will be equipped with dazzling LED streetlights that are expected to brighten up the area by almost forty per cent, when they detect approaching vehicles. Officials from West Bengal's Housing Infrastructure Development Corp., which has taken up the task of installing the lights, have stated that the automated technology used in these streetlights will turn them on after sunset and turn them off at dawn. Currently, all streetlights in the city are manually controlled from various operating centres.

India to set up renewable projects along India-Pakistan border

India will set up solar and wind projects on fallow land along its international border with Pakistan. By doing this, India plans to address the issue of land availability for clean energy projects. A thirty-kilometre-long and twenty-kilometre-wide parcel of land has been identified along the border in Kutch district of Gujarat, which stretches along the border in Bikaner, Barmer and Jaisalmer districts of Rajasthan.

STL Academy to train village-level entrepreneurs in optical-fibre networking

Sterlite Technology and Common Services Centres (CSC) Academy have signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) to train village-level entrepreneurs in optical-fibre networking. The companies have come together to create highly-skilled fibre deployment specialists in rural India. Under the MoU, STL Academy will conduct a certified training programme for such entrepreneurs registered with CSC.

The government will fund the start-ups directly with seed money to build on this technology. It will also use the platform for furthering its own initiatives like translating videos of technical education lectures in local languages.

MeitY is also reportedly in conversation with IIT Madras, International Institute of Information Technology Hyderabad, Centre for Development of Advanced Computing in Pune and Indian Institute of Science for turning this project into a success.

Exide Industries to start assembling lithium-ion batteries

Gautam Chatterjee, managing director and chief executive officer of Exide industries, told *PTI* that the company will begin assembling lithium-ion batteries from imported cells of China, starting December. It will make batteries for several applications including electric vehicles (EVs) depending on demand.

Exide had announced a joint venture (JV) with Switzerland-based Leclanché SA, one of the world's leading energy storage solution companies,

in June last year. The JV was formed between the two companies in a 75:25 ratio. The JV company's production plant in Gujarat is the first such indigenous facility in the country for manufacturing lithium-ion batteries and providing energy storage systems for the EV market.

According to a report by Adroit Market Research, the global lithium-ion battery market size is estimated to touch nearly US\$ 105 billion by 2025, owing to increasing demand for consumer electronics and EVs.

The automotive segment is anticipated to be the fastest-growing segment in the coming years. Fast-paced development of the EV sector is the key reason behind the growing usage of lithium-ion batteries in the automotive industry.

Panasonic teams up with IBM Japan to enhance semiconductor manufacturing

Panasonic Corp.'s subsidiary, Panasonic Smart Factory Solutions Co., has collaborated with IBM Japan to develop and market a new high-val-

ue-added system to utilise the overall equipment effectiveness of customers' semiconductor manufacturing processes. IBM Japan and Panasonic will jointly develop a data analysis system that will be incorporated into Panasonic's Edge devices. The aim of the companies is to significantly reduce the number of engineering processes required and to improve the operating rates of manufacturing facilities.

The system aims to develop an automatic recipe generation system for plasma dicers, which is a new advanced packaging production method that is drawing increased attention in the semiconductor manufacturing field, and a process control system that incorporates an FDC system in plasma cleaners.

Panasonic currently develops and markets Edge devices and manufacturing methods that contribute to improving semiconductor manufacturing of advanced packaging. These new devices and methods include dry etching equipment, plasma dicers to produce high-quality wafers, plasma cleaners that increase metal and resin adhesion, and high-accuracy bonding devices.